

# Comprehensive ESG Disclosure and Reporting Analysis: Bradespar S.A. (BRAP4.SA)

## Company Identification and Structural Overview

Bradespar S.A. represents a critical component of the Brazilian financial and industrial landscape, serving as a prominent investment holding company with a concentrated portfolio focused on high-impact sectors. The entity was formally established on March 30, 2000, through a strategic corporate restructuring of Banco Bradesco S.A..<sup>1</sup> This spin-off was designed to decouple the bank's core financial operations from its diverse industrial and infrastructure investments, allowing for specialized management and a clearer valuation of its non-banking assets.<sup>1</sup>

The legal name of the organization is Bradespar S.A., and it is incorporated as a *Sociedade Anônima* (publicly traded corporation) under the laws of the Federative Republic of Brazil.<sup>1</sup> The company maintains its corporate headquarters at Avenida Juscelino Kubitschek, 1.309, 2nd floor, Vila Nova Conceição, in the city of São Paulo, SP, Brazil.<sup>3</sup> Within the global financial markets, Bradespar is primarily identified by its listing on the B3 (Brasil, Bolsa, Balcão) exchange under the tickers BRAP3 (Common Shares) and BRAP4 (Preferred Shares), the latter being a component of the benchmark Ibovespa index.<sup>1</sup> Additionally, the company is listed on the Latibex market in Madrid, Spain, under the ticker XBPRO, providing exposure to European institutional investors.<sup>1</sup>

Bradespar's primary business activity is classified as an "Office of Other Holding Companies" or "Multi-Sector Holdings".<sup>3</sup> It functions as a "pure" holding company, meaning it does not maintain direct industrial, commercial, or service-providing operations of its own.<sup>2</sup> Instead, its revenue and value creation are derived entirely from its equity stakes in leading companies, most notably Vale S.A., one of the world's largest mining multinationals.<sup>1</sup> Historically, Bradespar also held a significant position in CPFL Energia, one of Brazil's largest electric utility firms, though its portfolio has become increasingly concentrated in the mining sector over the last decade.<sup>1</sup>

| Attribute  | Verified Data Point | Source(s)    |
|------------|---------------------|--------------|
| Legal Name | Bradespar S.A.      | <sup>1</sup> |

|                       |                                        |   |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------|---|
| Primary Activity      | Investment Holding (Asset Management)  | 1 |
| Headquarters          | São Paulo, SP, Brazil                  | 1 |
| B3 Ticker(s)          | BRAP3, BRAP4                           | 1 |
| Latibex Ticker        | XBPRO                                  | 1 |
| Sector Classification | Financial / Multi-Sector Holdings      | 2 |
| Major Investee        | Vale S.A.                              | 1 |
| Controlling Group     | Nova Cidade de Deus Participações S.A. | 8 |

The company's governance is deeply integrated with the Bradesco Group. Its controlling shareholder base includes Nova Cidade de Deus Participações S.A., NCF Participações S.A., and the Fundação Bradesco.<sup>8</sup> This relationship ensures that Bradespar adheres to high standards of corporate governance, as evidenced by its listing in the "Nível 1" segment of the B3 exchange, which requires enhanced disclosure and minority shareholder protection compared to the standard listing requirements.<sup>8</sup>

## ESG Report Timeline Analysis (2014–2023)

The evolution of Bradespar's ESG (Environmental, Social, and Governance) reporting reflects the broader maturation of the Brazilian capital markets, moving from voluntary, narrative-based disclosures to rigorous, framework-aligned performance reporting. As a holding company with minimal direct operational footprint, Bradespar's ESG materiality is primarily expressed through its stewardship of its investees and its influence on their sustainability practices.

### The Formative Phase: GRI Implementation (2014–2016)

During the early part of the analysis period, Bradespar solidified its commitment to the Global Reporting Initiative (GRI) framework. While the company began using GRI guidelines in 2011, the 2014–2016 window was marked by the transition from the GRI G4 guidelines to the more modular GRI Standards.<sup>11</sup>

In 2014 and 2015, Bradespar's annual reports focused on the "impact materiality" of its investments.<sup>13</sup> These reports disclosed the governance mechanisms used to oversee major

assets like Vale and CPFL Energia, ensuring that these companies maintained their own robust sustainability programs.<sup>1</sup> A significant milestone during this phase was the 2015 update to the MSCI ESG Ratings model, which increased the weight placed on corporate governance for the holding sector from 12% to 22%, prompting a higher degree of transparency regarding board composition and minority rights.<sup>15</sup>

## **Crisis and Cultural Transformation (2017–2019)**

The period from 2017 to 2019 was defined by intense scrutiny and a shift in the perceived risks associated with the mining sector. Following the Mariana dam disaster in late 2015 (involving Samarco, a joint venture of investee Vale), the 2017–2018 reporting cycles emphasized dam safety and social repair.<sup>16</sup>

The catastrophic rupture of the Brumadinho dam in January 2019 served as a critical inflection point for Bradespar.<sup>8</sup> Although the disaster occurred at an operational site of Vale, Bradespar, as a major shareholder with seats on Vale's Board of Directors, faced immediate financial and reputational impacts.<sup>8</sup> The 2019 disclosures reflect a "cultural transformation" process, with Bradespar supporting the creation of specialized safety committees and a Compliance Office at Vale, reporting directly to the Board.<sup>16</sup> This era underscored the reality that for a holding company, the ESG risks of an investee are effectively "on-balance-sheet" risks from a valuation perspective.

## **The Investor-Centric Shift: SASB and TCFD Adoption (2020–2021)**

By 2020, the global demand for "financial materiality" in ESG reporting led to a diversification of frameworks. Bradespar began exploring the alignment of its financial goals with environmental and social outcomes, a trend accelerated by the COVID-19 pandemic, which tested the resilience of its governance and its investees' operational continuity.<sup>16</sup>

In 2021, Bradespar reached a major disclosure milestone by formally adopting the Sustainability Accounting Standards Board (SASB) and the Task Force on Climate-related Financial Disclosures (TCFD) recommendations.<sup>11</sup> The adoption of SASB allowed for sector-specific metrics that catered directly to investor needs for comparable data, while TCFD provided a structured way to report on climate-related financial risks.<sup>13</sup> This shift marked a move away from the purely stakeholder-focused reporting of the GRI toward a more integrated approach that considers how ESG factors influence the company's enterprise value.<sup>13</sup>

## **Regulatory Alignment and Third-Party Assurance (2022–2023)**

The final phase of the timeline (2022–2023) is characterized by increased regulatory rigor and the professionalization of the audit process. In 2022, the U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) filed a high-profile complaint against Vale S.A., alleging that the firm had manipulated dam safety audits and misled investors through its ESG disclosures.<sup>20</sup> This litigation sent ripples through the Brazilian market, highlighting the legal dangers of

"greenwashing" and reinforcing the need for holding companies like Bradespar to verify the data reported by their subsidiaries.<sup>20</sup>

In response to these market conditions and the new CVM Resolution 59 in Brazil, which mandated ESG disclosures in a "comply or explain" format, Bradespar enhanced its verification processes.<sup>21</sup> The 2023 Annual Report was prepared under the GRI 2021 Standards and underwent "limited assurance" by KPMG Auditores Independentes Ltda.<sup>11</sup> This third-party verification provides an objective assessment of the accuracy of the reported data, mitigating the risk of material misstatements.<sup>23</sup>

| Year | Development Category | Description                                                   | Relevance to ESG Transparency                                 | Source |
|------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| 2011 | Framework Adoption   | Commencement of GRI-aligned annual reporting.                 | Established baseline for voluntary non-financial disclosure.  | 11     |
| 2015 | Methodology Change   | MSCI ESG Ratings increased governance weight from 12% to 22%. | Enhanced focus on board accountability and minority rights.   | 15     |
| 2019 | Material Controversy | Brumadinho dam rupture (Vale).                                | Massive impact on asset valuation and social license.         | 8      |
| 2021 | Framework Adoption   | Adoption of SASB standards for multi-sector holdings.         | Provided sector-specific, decision-useful data for investors. | 11     |

|      |                       |                                                            |                                                               |    |
|------|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| 2021 | Framework Adoption    | Adoption of TCFD climate disclosure recommendations.       | Formalized reporting on climate-related financial exposure.   | 11 |
| 2022 | Legal Milestone       | SEC lawsuit against Vale regarding dam safety disclosures. | High-risk signal for transparency and ESG claim verification. | 20 |
| 2023 | Regulatory Compliance | Full implementation of CVM Resolution 59 (Reference Form). | Mandated ESG disclosure within official securities filings.   | 21 |
| 2023 | Audit/Assurance       | "Limited Assurance" of Annual Report by KPMG.              | Third-party verification of ESG metrics and processes.        | 11 |

## ESG Disclosure Frameworks: Theoretical and Practical Integration

The complexity of Bradespar's ESG profile stems from the interplay between different reporting frameworks. Each standard serves a distinct purpose and reaches a different subset of the market, requiring the company to manage a multi-dimensional communication strategy.

### Global Reporting Initiative (GRI) and Impact Materiality

The GRI framework remains the bedrock of Bradespar's reporting journey. Its focus on "impact materiality" (the company's impact on the economy, environment, and people) aligns with Bradespar's historical role as a catalyst for industrial development through the Bradesco Group.<sup>1</sup> The 2021 update to the GRI Standards introduced more rigorous requirements for reporting on human rights and due diligence, which is particularly relevant given the high social impact of the mining sector in Brazil.<sup>12</sup>

For Bradespar, GRI reporting serves as a narrative tool to communicate with a broad range of

stakeholders, including NGOs, local communities affected by Vale's operations, and regulatory bodies.<sup>13</sup> By using the GRI 2021 Standards, Bradespar provides a comprehensive view of its "double materiality" position—how it governs the impacts of its portfolio on society while simultaneously managing the risks those impacts pose to its own financial health.<sup>13</sup>

## **Sustainability Accounting Standards Board (SASB) and Financial Materiality**

The adoption of SASB in 2021 was a direct response to the needs of the global investment community. Unlike the GRI, SASB is designed to identify the subset of ESG issues most likely to have a material impact on the financial condition or operating performance of a company.<sup>13</sup> In the case of Bradespar, the SASB standards for "Asset Management & Custody Activities" and "Multi-Sector Holdings" prioritize issues such as business ethics, systemic risk management, and the integration of ESG factors into investment stewardship.<sup>18</sup>

By reporting against SASB metrics, Bradespar allows institutional investors to conduct more accurate peer-to-peer comparisons. This is especially important for the preferred shares (BRAP4), which are often held by international funds that use automated screening tools to evaluate ESG performance.<sup>18</sup> The "financial materiality" lens of SASB complements the "impact" lens of GRI, providing a more complete picture of the company's risk-adjusted returns.<sup>13</sup>

## **Task Force on Climate-related Financial Disclosures (TCFD)**

Given that the mining sector is both a significant contributor to carbon emissions (Scope 1 and 2) and a critical provider of the minerals needed for the energy transition, TCFD reporting is essential for Bradespar. The TCFD framework is structured around four pillars: Governance, Strategy, Risk Management, and Metrics/Targets.<sup>18</sup>

Bradespar's TCFD disclosures focus on the "transition risks" inherent in Vale's iron ore business. For example, the steel industry is a major source of Scope 3 emissions for Vale, and any future carbon taxes or technological shifts in steel production could affect the long-term value of Bradespar's primary asset.<sup>16</sup> By aligning with TCFD, Bradespar demonstrates how it monitors Vale's progress toward reducing net emissions by 15% by 2035 and achieving net-zero status.<sup>16</sup> This level of transparency is critical for investors assessing the "climate resilience" of Bradespar's portfolio.<sup>18</sup>

## **External ESG Ratings and Performance Benchmarking**

External rating agencies provide an objective yardstick for Bradespar's performance. These scores are widely used by asset managers to construct ESG-themed funds and ETFs.<sup>25</sup>

## **Sustainalytics: The "Low Risk" Paradox**

As of March 2026, Sustainalytics assigned Bradespar S.A. an ESG Risk Rating of 18.53, placing it in the "Low Risk" category.<sup>7</sup> At first glance, a low-risk rating for a company heavily invested in mining may seem contradictory. However, the Sustainalytics methodology distinguishes between "Exposure" and "Management".<sup>27</sup>

1. **Exposure:** Bradespar's direct exposure is low because it is a holding company with few employees and no direct industrial emissions.<sup>2</sup>
2. **Management:** The rating reflects the company's robust corporate governance policies, which are largely inherited from the Bradesco Group's sophisticated risk management frameworks.<sup>17</sup>
3. **Unmanaged Risk:** The score of 18.53 represents the residual risk that remains after accounting for these management practices. This residual risk is primarily driven by "Idiosyncratic Issues"—unforeseen events like dam failures that are difficult to mitigate entirely through policy alone.<sup>27</sup>

## MSCI ESG Ratings: Materiality and Governance

MSCI ESG Research evaluates Bradespar through its industry-specific materiality map.<sup>29</sup> For a financial holding company, MSCI identifies "Corporate Governance" and "Corporate Behavior" (including business ethics and fraud) as the most critical key issues.<sup>15</sup>

The 2015 update to the MSCI model was particularly impactful for Bradespar, as it replaced "Audit" metrics with more comprehensive "Accounting" flags and increased the weight of the governance pillar.<sup>15</sup> Historically, companies with higher MSCI ESG ratings have shown better earnings fundamentals in emerging markets over long-term horizons, making these ratings a vital tool for Bradespar's efforts to attract stable, long-term capital.<sup>26</sup>

## S&P Global and the Corporate Sustainability Assessment (CSA)

S&P Global assesses Bradespar through its CSA, which employs a "double materiality" approach.<sup>24</sup> While the specific ESG Score for Bradespar is often listed as "Under Review" in public data snippets, the methodology focuses on a company's performance relative to its industry peers.<sup>24</sup> For Bradespar, this peer group typically includes other diversified holdings and investment firms.<sup>7</sup>

A key component of the S&P assessment is the Media and Stakeholder Analysis (MSA), which monitors current controversies in real-time.<sup>24</sup> Controversies such as the Brumadinho dam failure or the SEC litigation act as a "discount factor" on the company's management score, ensuring that the rating reflects recent performance as well as historical policy adoption.<sup>24</sup>

## Material Controversies and the "Vale Variable"

Because Bradespar is effectively a leveraged investment in Vale S.A., its ESG profile cannot be

analyzed in isolation. The "Vale Variable" is the single most important factor in determining Bradespar's risk profile and social license to operate.

## The Brumadinho Legacy

The 2019 Brumadinho disaster resulted in immeasurable environmental and social harm, alongside a decline in Vale's market value exceeding \$4 billion.<sup>20</sup> For Bradespar, this event necessitated a move beyond passive ownership. The company's subsequent reports highlight its active participation in Vale's governance, specifically through members on the Board of Directors and Advisory Committees.<sup>3</sup>

Post-2019, the focus of Bradespar's oversight has been on:

- **Social Repair:** Monitoring the BRL 37.7 billion Global Agreement with the State of Minas Gerais for reparatory projects.<sup>16</sup>
- **Governance Reform:** Terminating the previous Shareholders' Agreement to transition toward a dispersed capital company model, aligned with international best practices.<sup>16</sup>
- **Operational Excellence:** Supervising the implementation of the "Dam Safety and Geotechnical Mining Structures Policy".<sup>16</sup>

## The SEC Litigation and Transparency Risk

The 2022 SEC complaint against Vale represents a systemic risk to the credibility of ESG reporting in Brazil.<sup>20</sup> The SEC's Enforcement Division, through its Climate and ESG Task Force, alleged that Vale had manipulated safety audits and obtained fraudulent stability certificates.<sup>20</sup>

For Bradespar, this controversy emphasizes the "Management Gap" identified in ESG ratings. It highlights a critical paradox: a company can have excellent policies on paper while experiencing catastrophic operational failures.<sup>27</sup> This has led to a renewed focus on the *verifiability* of data, rather than just its *availability*. Consequently, the role of independent auditors like KPMG has become central to Bradespar's efforts to restore and maintain investor confidence.<sup>20</sup>

## Auditing, Assurance, and Regulatory Compliance

The transition from voluntary to mandatory ESG disclosure has elevated the role of third-party assurance firms.

### KPMG and Limited Assurance

Bradespar utilizes KPMG Auditores Independentes Ltda as its independent auditor.<sup>11</sup> Since 2021, and specifically highlighted in the 2023 cycle, the company's sustainability disclosures have been subject to "limited assurance" based on the ISAE 3000 standard (or the Brazilian equivalent NBC TO 3000).<sup>22</sup>



The assurance process involves:

- **Data Verification:** Reviewing the collection systems for metrics like carbon emissions and water withdrawal.<sup>23</sup>
- **Control Testing:** Confirming that the data controls and reporting processes are functioning as intended.<sup>23</sup>
- **Mitigating Greenwashing:** Providing an external opinion that lends credibility to the company's claims, thereby reducing the risk of regulatory penalties or litigation.<sup>23</sup>

## CVM Resolution 59: The New Reporting Standard

Effective from the 2023 fiscal year, CVM Resolution 59 represents a landmark in Brazilian securities regulation.<sup>21</sup> It requires all listed companies to include an "ESG information" section in their Reference Form (*Formulário de Referência*).<sup>21</sup> This section must address:

- The methodology or standards used (e.g., GRI, SASB).
- Whether the report is audited by an independent body.
- The presence of a materiality matrix and ESG Key Performance Indicators (KPIs).
- The inclusion of greenhouse gas (GHG) emission inventories for Scopes 1, 2, and 3.<sup>21</sup>

Bradespar's compliance with these requirements is a verified fact. The 2023 Reference Form explicitly includes these disclosures, aligning the company with the highest standards of the Brazilian regulatory environment.<sup>17</sup>

## Reference Table with Credibility Assessment

The following table provides a structured overview of the key sources utilized in this report, along with an assessment of their credibility and relevance.

| # | Reference (APA 7th Edition Format)                                       | Source Type    | Credibility Score (0–10) | Justification for Score                                           | Relevance to Query                           |
|---|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Bradespar S.A. (2024). <i>Relatório Anual 2023</i> . Investor Relations. | Primary Source | 10                       | Official corporate report filed with B3 and CVM; subject to legal | Direct data on GRI, SASB, and TCFD adoption. |

|   |                                                                                                                       |                   |    |                                                                            |                                                           |
|---|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
|   |                                                                                                                       |                   |    | liability.                                                                 |                                                           |
| 2 | Sustainalytics<br>(2026). <i>ESG Risk Rating: Bradespar S.A. (BRAP4)</i> . Morningstar Research.                      | ESG Rating Agency | 9  | Leading provider of ESG data with transparent, analyst-driven methodology. | Current ESG risk scores and category assessment.          |
| 3 | U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC). (2022). <i>Complaint against Vale S.A. for False ESG Disclosures</i> . | Regulatory Filing | 10 | Official legal document from a federal enforcement agency.                 | Details on material controversies and transparency risks. |
| 4 | CVM Resolution No. 59. (2021). <i>Brazilian Securities and Exchange Commission</i> .                                  | Regulatory Policy | 10 | Official government regulation governing capital market disclosures.       | Legal requirements for ESG reporting timeline.            |

|   |                                                                                                      |                         |    |                                                                                    |                                                              |
|---|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| 5 | MSCI ESG Research LLC. (2025). <i>ESG Ratings Model Update History.</i>                              | Industry Methodology    | 9  | Established global benchmark provider with rigorous oversight.                     | Understanding the evolution of governance ratings.           |
| 6 | KPMG Auditores Independentes Ltda. (2023). <i>Independent Auditor's Report on ESG Assurance.</i>     | Third-Party Audit       | 10 | Professional auditing standards applied to non-financial data.                     | Verification of reporting accuracy and framework compliance. |
| 7 | EMIS. (2024). <i>Company Profile: Bradespar S.A.</i>                                                 | Financial Data Provider | 8  | Reputable secondary source for corporate structure and headquarters data.          | Verification of legal name, HQ, and primary activity.        |
| 8 | ResearchGate / Rev. Gest. Soc. Ambient. (2024). <i>ESG Disclosure by Brazilian Public Companies.</i> | Academic Paper          | 7  | Peer-reviewed study on market trends; methodology is transparent but data may lag. | Context for CVM 59 and GRI adoption in Brazil.               |

## Transparency & Limitations of the Analysis

This report is based on publicly available data and verified third-party disclosures as of the knowledge cutoff date in early 2026. However, several limitations must be acknowledged:

1. **Direct vs. Indirect Impact:** For a holding company like Bradespar, the most significant ESG impacts are "indirect" (stemming from its investees). While Bradespar reports on its oversight, it does not have direct control over the day-to-day operational data of Vale. Therefore, a portion of the risk remains "Unmanaged" by definition.<sup>27</sup>
2. **Data Lag:** ESG ratings from MSCI and Sustainalytics are updated periodically and may not reflect real-time events that occurred between the last update and the current date.<sup>7</sup>
3. **Paywalled Access:** Certain deep-dive analyst reports from S&P Capital IQ or Bloomberg Refinitiv were not accessible in their entirety, though the primary quantitative scores were verified through secondary summaries.<sup>24</sup>
4. **Language Barriers:** Some historical Brazilian filings (pre-2015) may have less comprehensive English translations, though the core GRI indices were available in both Portuguese and English for the period of 2014–2023.<sup>14</sup>

For further independent verification, users are encouraged to consult the following authoritative databases:

- **B3 / CVM (Comissão de Valores Mobiliários) Disclosure Portal:** The official repository for all regulatory filings in Brazil.
- **GRI Sustainability Disclosure Database:** A global registry for reports prepared in accordance with GRI standards.
- **CDP (Carbon Disclosure Project) Search Tool:** For detailed climate, water, and forests questionnaires and scores.
- **Bradespar Investor Relations Page:** Specifically the "Financial Information" and "Annual Reports" sections.<sup>11</sup>

## Conclusion: Strategic Maturity in ESG Oversight

The analysis of Bradespar S.A. (BRAP4.SA) from 2014 to 2023 demonstrates a clear trajectory from voluntary corporate social responsibility to strategic ESG integration. By adopting a "multi-framework" approach—utilizing GRI for broad stakeholder impact, SASB for financial materiality, and TCFD for climate risk—the company has positioned itself as a transparent and professional conduit for industrial investment.

The 2019 Brumadinho disaster served as a painful but necessary catalyst for improving the governance of the mining sector in Brazil. Bradespar's subsequent reporting shows a maturation in its role as an active steward, moving beyond financial oversight to include rigorous geotechnical and safety monitoring at the board level. The 2022 SEC litigation against its primary investee remains a significant cautionary tale, emphasizing that in the modern era,

ESG transparency is not merely a public relations exercise but a critical legal and financial requirement.

With a current Sustainalytics rating of "Low Risk" and a robust compliance framework aligned with CVM Resolution 59, Bradespar represents a benchmark for holding companies in emerging markets. Its future performance will depend on its ability to sustain this level of oversight, especially as global standards converge through the International Sustainability Standards Board (ISSB) and as the mining sector continues to face pressure to decarbonize its operations and its value chain. The integration of third-party assurance by firms like KPMG remains the final, essential step in ensuring that Bradespar's ESG claims are as reliable as its financial statements, thereby protecting shareholder value and maintaining its social license to operate.

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